

Marketing Research

Mike Nguyen

2021-01-02

Contents

1	Prerequisites	5
2	Introduction	7
3	Advertising	9
4	Brand Equity	11
5	Celebrity Endorsement	13
6	Virality	15
6.1	Impression Management	16
6.2	Emotion regulation	18
6.3	Information acquisition	19
6.4	Social bonding	20
6.5	Persuading others	20
6.6	Moderators	20
7	Finance-Marketing Interface	23
7.1	Tobin's q	23
7.2	Event study	25
8	Advertising	27

Chapter 1

Prerequisites

Chapter 2

Introduction

You can label chapter and section titles using `{#label}` after them, e.g., we can reference Chapter 2. If you do not manually label them, there will be automatic labels anyway, e.g., Chapter ??.

Figures and tables with captions will be placed in `figure` and `table` environments, respectively.

```
par(mar = c(4, 4, .1, .1))  
plot(pressure, type = 'b', pch = 19)
```

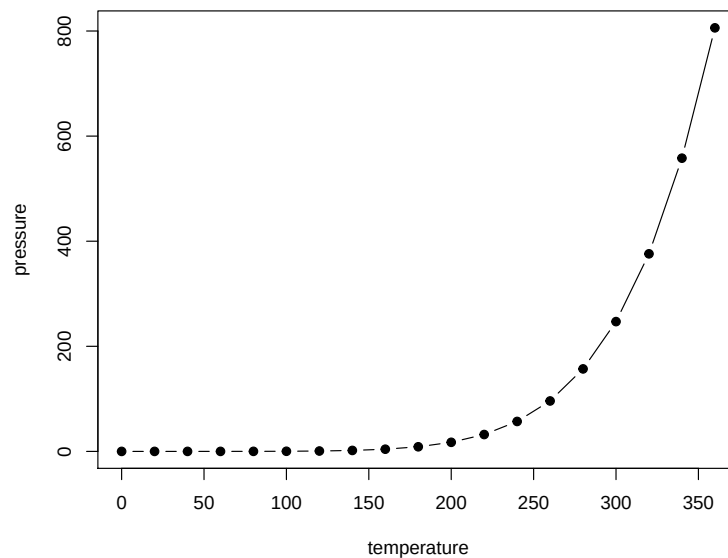


Figure 2.1: Here is a nice figure!

Table 2.1: Here is a nice table!

Sepal.Length	Sepal.Width	Petal.Length	Petal.Width	Species
5.1	3.5	1.4	0.2	setosa
4.9	3.0	1.4	0.2	setosa
4.7	3.2	1.3	0.2	setosa
4.6	3.1	1.5	0.2	setosa
5.0	3.6	1.4	0.2	setosa
5.4	3.9	1.7	0.4	setosa
4.6	3.4	1.4	0.3	setosa
5.0	3.4	1.5	0.2	setosa
4.4	2.9	1.4	0.2	setosa
4.9	3.1	1.5	0.1	setosa
5.4	3.7	1.5	0.2	setosa
4.8	3.4	1.6	0.2	setosa
4.8	3.0	1.4	0.1	setosa
4.3	3.0	1.1	0.1	setosa
5.8	4.0	1.2	0.2	setosa
5.7	4.4	1.5	0.4	setosa
5.4	3.9	1.3	0.4	setosa
5.1	3.5	1.4	0.3	setosa
5.7	3.8	1.7	0.3	setosa
5.1	3.8	1.5	0.3	setosa

Reference a figure by its code chunk label with the `fig:` prefix, e.g., see Figure 2.1. Similarly, you can reference tables generated from `knitr::kable()`, e.g., see Table 2.1.

```
knitr::kable(
  head(iris, 20), caption = 'Here is a nice table!',
  booktabs = TRUE
)
```

You can write citations, too. For example, we are using the **bookdown** package (Xie, 2020) in this sample book, which was built on top of R Markdown and **knitr** (Xie, 2015).

Chapter 3

Advertising

Prior distribution for TV advertising elasticity for consumer packaged goods can be found in (Shapiro et al., 2018). A substantial portion of products has statistically insignificant or negative estimates for advertising elasticity. TV ads might not be the best vehicle to reach the customer now.

Chapter 4

Brand Equity

Chapter 5

Celebrity Endorsement

Based on Power Distance Theory, power distance beliefs moderates the positive effect of celebrity endorsers on evaluations of advertising (Winterich et al., 2018)

Chapter 6

Virality

The age group from 18-24 can be more challenging to target since they reported fewer positive responses compared to other age groups (Libert, 2014). Since their threshold is higher due to the overwhelming digital content they encounter, their emotions are harder to activate.

Wide gaps between two opposing opinions can increase future discussion (reviews); however, fluctuation around one opinion does not. Higher informational content moderate positively the relationship between opposing opinions and future reviews. (Nagle and Riedl, 2014)

WOM should be taken under the context of the evolution of conversation. (Berger, 2014)

Valuable virality (Akpinar and Berger, 2017)

Establishes causality of appeals and brand integralness to virality.

- Compared to informative appeal ads (focus on product features), emotional appeal ads (drama, mood, music, emotion-eliciting strategies) are more likely to be shared.
- Informative appeals boost brand evaluations and purchase because the brand is an integral part of the ad content.
- Hence, to combine the best of both worlds, emotional brand-integral ads boost sharing while also bolstering brand-related outcomes (embedded the brand into the stories).
- The mechanism that ads affect brand evaluation through two simultaneous mechanisms: persuasive attempt and brand knowledge.

“keeping viewers involved depends in large part on two emotions: joy and sur-

prise”(Teixeira, 2012) - “Research: The Emotions that Make Marketing Campaigns Go Viral”

“ads that produce stable emotional states generally aren’t effective at engaging viewers for very long.” And “shock may get people to watch an ad privately, it often works against their desire to share the spot. Like Clothing Drive that try to mimic “Swear Jar” by Bud Light” (Teixeira, 2012)

(Westbrook, 1987, p. 261) defined WOM as “informational communication directed at other consumers about the ownership, usage, or characteristics of particular goods and services or their sellers.” WOM evolves to “word of mouse” (or e-WOM).

(Berger, 2014):

WOM is goal-driven and serves five key functions:

- Impression Management
- Emotion regulation
- Information acquisition
- Social bonding
- Persuasion

The motivation behind this process is self-serving and even subconscious level. Hence, we can predict the types of news and information people are most likely to discuss.

- Over 70% of everyday speech is about the self, such as personal experiences or relationships (Dunbar et al., 1997). Consistent with previous research, online behaviors exhibit the same pattern: over 70% of social media posts are about self (Naaman et al., 2010).
- At any given point in time, multiple drivers can be present.

6.1 Impression Management

Consumers buy to signal their derived identities to achieve desired impressions (J. Berger & Heath, 2007)

Interpersonal communication (WOM) influences impression management in 3 ways: (1) self-enhancement, (2) identity-signaling, and (3) filling conversational space.

- **Self-enhancement:** human has a tendency to self-enhance (Markus, 1987). Hence, people like to share things to help them look good (Chung & Darke, 2006; Hennig-Thurau et al., 2004). Since bragging too much

about oneself might have an opposite effect. People sometimes engage in "humblebragging": brag but self-deprecating at the same time. (Sezer et al., 2018)

- **Identity-signalling:** they talk about themselves to signal they have certain traits or expertise (G. Packard & Wooten, 2013), such as opinion leaders talk to signal their identity (share to show their knowledge).
- **Filling conversational space:** (small talk) people engage in small talk to avoid pauses and silence in between conversations so that the other party would not make lousy inferences about the person. (J. Berger, 2014)

Hence impression management induces people to share things that are

- **Entertaining** (i.e., interesting, surprising, funny or extreme) so that they shared look more interesting, and in-the-know. Interesting products get more word of mouth (J. Berger & Iyengar, 2013; J. Berger & Milkman, 2012; J. Berger & Schwartz, 2011). Moderate controversy is a catalyst for word of mouth to spread (Chen & Berger, 2013). And sometimes, people even exaggerate stories to make things more interesting (C. Heath, 1996); around 60% of the stories are distorted (Marsh & Tversky, 2004)
- **Useful:** because it makes the sharer smart and helpful. Empirical evidence show that useful stories (J. Berger & Milkman, 2012) and higher quality brands (Lovett et al., 2013) are more likely to be shared.
- **Self-concept relevant:** different people see different domain as the optimal signal amplifier such as politics, economics, etc. hence symbolic products are more likely to be shared than utilitarian ones (Chung & Darke, 2006) (even though useful information is helpful, but the signal to be smart and helpful are not appreciated as being interesting and entertaining).
- **Status related:** premium brands are talked about more (Lovett et al., 2013). Knowledge is can also be considered as a status symbol, and people share to signal that they re in the know (Ritson & Elliott, 1999)
- **Unique:** unique products are more likely to be shared, but people with a high need for uniqueness will be less likely to share positive WOM because they do not want people to adopt the product and reduces their uniqueness (Cheema & Kaikati, 2010). Sometimes they even scare others by citing product complexity (Moldovan et al., 2015)
- **Common ground:** sharing common things induces listener to convey that there is interpersonal similarity and facilitates conversation.
- **Emotional valence:** people prefer to share positive things than negative

news (J. Berger & Milkman, 2012). However, in some special cases, negative WOM can be perceived as a desired component such as reviewers are seen as more intelligent, (Amabile, 1983). Which is moderated by whether people are refereeing to themselves or others will affect WOM valence (positive vs. negative)(Kamins et al., 1997). Positive WOM when talking oneself conveys a positive image, while negative WOM about others convey that they are relatively better than the other party.

- **Incidental arousal:** unrelated arousal (e.g., running in place) can increase sharing in general (J. Berger, 2011) because of the increase in arousal levels.
- **Accessible things:** products with more cued or triggered will be discussed more (J. Berger & Schwartz, 2011). Hence, more advertised products generate more WOM (Onishi & Manchanda, 2012). “top of mind” and “tip of the tongue.” Availability bias means that the easier we can recall something, the more likely we are going to talk about it. Publicly visible products also have more WOM (J. Berger & Schwartz, 2011)

6.2 Emotion regulation

WOM help consumers regulate their emotions. Emotion regulation refers to “a person’s ability to effectively manage and respond to an emotional experience” (Rolston & Lloyd-Richardson, 2017). and sharing with other (WOM) can facilitate emotion regulation by:

- **Generating social support:** sharing can give you comfort and consolation (Rimé, 2009). For example, after a negative emotional experience, sharing can help increase well-being through perceived social support (J. A. Berger & Buechel, 2012)
- **Venting:** WOM (sharing) helps people achieve catharsis when experiencing negative experiences(Alicke et al., 1992): consumers express when they are angry (Wetzer et al., 2007) or dissatisfied (Anderson, 1998).
- **Sensemaking:** “talking can help people understand what they feel and why” (J. Berger, 2014)
- **Reducing dissonance:** even after making a decision, we want to make sure we make the right choice by talking to others to reduce feelings of doubt (Rosnow, 1980)
- **Taking vengeance:** to punish the company (different from venting, which makes you feel better), consumers share negative consumption experience (Ward & Ostrom, 2006)

- **Rehearsal:** people talk to relive positive experiences (Rimé, 2009)

Emotion regulation drives people to share (1) emotional content (2) influence the valence of the content shared, (3) lead people to share more emotionally arousing content:

- **Emotionality:** more emotional intensity, more sharing (J. Berger & Milkman, 2012), people share more emotional social anecdotes (Peters et al., 2009). But not all emotions increase sharing: for example, shame and guilt decreases sharing (Finkenauer & Rimé, 1998) since sharing those things makes people look bad.
- **Valence:** “Emotion regulation tends to focus on the management of negative emotions” (J. Berger, 2014), but a counter vailing effect is that under impression management, people avoid sharing negative stories since it might reflect on the shares. Sharing negative things can decrease willingness to share (Chen & Berger, 2013)
- **Emotional arousal:**
 - **Negative** side: low arousal emotion (sadness), high arousal (anger or anxiety) should increase the need to vent.
 - **Positive** side: low arousal (contentment), high arousal (awe, excitement or amusement) increase desires for rehearsal.

6.3 Information acquisition

WOM helps acquire information.

- **Seeking advice:** (Hennig-Thurau et al., 2004; Rimé, 2009). Rather than trial and error, or direct observation, gossip serves as another form of learning (Baumeister et al., 2004)
- **Resolving problems:** online forums or other online opinion platforms help customers find a solution quickly from others (Hennig-Thurau et al., 2004)

Hence the process of information acquisition would induce to talk more about

- **Risky, important, complex, or uncertainty-ridden decision:** talking to others can reduce risk, simplify complexity, and increase consumer’s confidence (Hennig-Thurau et al., 2004)
- **Lack of (trustworthy) information:**

6.4 Social bonding

“people have a fundamental desire for social relationships (Baumeister & Leary, 1995), and interpersonal communication fills that need (Hennig-Thurau et al., 2004)”. Empirically, people in brand communities because want to connect with others like them (Muniz & O’Guinn, 2001). Sharing facilitates social bonding through

- **Reinforce shared views:** group memberships, and one’s place in the social hierarchy. WOM (sharing) allows people to fit in as a group member (J. Berger & Heath, 2007; Ritson & Elliott, 1999)
- **Reducing loneliness and social exclusion:** sharing decrease interpersonal distance and decreases loneliness and exclusion (Maner et al., 2007)

Social bonding drives what people share: people share things are :

- **Common ground:** social bonding drives people to talk about things they have in common because it makes them feel socially connected (Clark & Kashima, 2007)
- **Emotionality:** “sharing an emotional story or narrative increases the chance that others will feel similarly” (J. Berger, 2014). Emotional similarity increase group cohesiveness (Barsade & Gibson, 2007). And emotion sharing and social bonding can be a simultaneous process since previous works found that emotion sharing bonds people (Peters & Kashima, 2007) and high arousal emotion increase social bonding needs (Chen & Berger, 2013)

6.5 Persuading others

people use WOM to persuade others to affect their satisfaction or choices (J. Berger, 2014). Persuasive drive people to share things that are

- **Emotionally polarized** (polarized valence): since the goal is to convince something is good or bad (i.e., people share extremely rather than moderately positive(negative) information
- **Arousing content:** “people who want to persuade others may find shared arousing content to incite others to take desired actions” (J. Berger, 2014)

6.6 Moderators

- Two key moderators when different WOM functions have a greater impact:
 - **Communication audience:**
 - * Tie strength
 - * Audience size
 - * Tie status

– **Communication Channel**

- * Written vs. oral
- * Identifiability: whether communicators are identifiable. (anonymously)
- * Audience salience: whether the audience is salient during communication (online communication, the audience is less salient).

Chapter 7

Finance-Marketing Interface

7.1 Tobin's q

Retrieve data from WRDS

```
# to set up connection from R to WRDS (https://wrds-www.wharton.upenn.edu/pages/support/programming)
library(RPostgres)
library(dplyr)

# I've set up wrds connection before hand. Please use your username and password here.

# wrds <- dbConnect(Postgres(),
#                   host='wrds-pgdata.wharton.upenn.edu',
#                   port=9737,
#                   dbname='wrds',
#                   sslmode='require',
#                   user='')

# Check variables (column headers) in COMP ANNUAL FUNDAMENTAL
#uses the already-established wrds connection to prepare the SQL query string and save the query
# check available databases: https://wrds-web.wharton.upenn.edu/wrds/tools/variable.cfm?vendor\_id
res <- dbSendQuery(wrds, "select column_name
                          from information_schema.columns
                          where table_schema='compa'
                          and table_name='funda'
                          order by column_name")

data <- dbFetch(res, n=-1) # fetches the data that results from running the query res against wrds
dbClearResult(res) # closes the connection
```

```
head(data)
```

```
##      column_name
## 1      acchg
## 2      acco
## 3      accrt
## 4      acctchg
## 5      acctstd
## 6      acdo

# select everything
res <- dbSendQuery(wrds, "select * from compa.funda")

# from compa.funda

# only select the following variables
res <- dbSendQuery(wrds, "select gvkey, datadate, fyear, indfmt, consol, popsrc, dataf")

## Warning in result_create(conn@ptr, statement): Closing open result set,
## cancelling previous query
data1 <- dbFetch(res, n=-1)
dbClearResult(res)

data = data1 %>%
  distinct(gvkey, datadate, fyear, tic, conmm, .keep_all = T)
```

Calculate Tobin's Q

```
tobin_q_dt = data %>%
  mutate(mkvalt = coalesce(mkvalt, 0),
         dltd = coalesce(dltd, 0),
         at = coalesce(at, 0),
         dlc = coalesce(dlc, 0),
         act = coalesce(act, 0)) %>%
  mutate(tobin_q = (mkvalt + ifelse((dlc - act) >= 0, as.numeric(dlc - act), 0) + dltd) / at)
  select(tobin_q, gvkey, datadate, fyear, conmm)
head(tobin_q_dt)
```

```
##      tobin_q  gvkey  datadate fyear      conmm
## 1      Inf 001000 1961-12-31 1961 A & E PLASTIK PAK INC
## 2      NaN 001000 1962-12-31 1962 A & E PLASTIK PAK INC
## 3      Inf 001000 1963-12-31 1963 A & E PLASTIK PAK INC
## 4 0.3686441 001000 1964-12-31 1964 A & E PLASTIK PAK INC
## 5 0.4995671 001000 1965-12-31 1965 A & E PLASTIK PAK INC
## 6 0.4563786 001000 1966-12-31 1966 A & E PLASTIK PAK INC
```


7.2 Event study

7.2.1 Abnormal Return

<https://rpubs.com/gregoryarobinson/315096>

<https://www.eventstudytools.com/introduction-event-study-methodology>

```
library(EventStudy)
```

Another package

<https://cran.r-project.org/web/packages/eventstudies/vignettes/replications.pdf>

```
library(eventstudies)
```

Replication of (Chen and Siems, 2004)

```
data(TerrorIndiceReturns)
data(TerrorAttack)
TerrorIndiceCAR <- lapply(1: ncol(TerrorIndiceReturns), function(x){
  # 10-day window around the event
  event <- phys2eventtime(na.omit(TerrorIndiceReturns[ , x,
    drop = FALSE])),
  TerrorAttack,
  10)
  # Estimate ARs
  esMean <- constantMeanReturn(event$z.e[which(attributes(event$z.e)$index
    %in% -30:-11), ],
    residual = FALSE)
  ar <- event$z.e - esMean
  ar <- window(ar, start = 0, end = 10)
  # CAR
  car <- remap.cumsum(ar, base = as.numeric(ar[1, 1]))
  names(car) <- colnames(TerrorIndiceReturns[ , x,
    drop = FALSE])
  return(car)
})
names(TerrorIndiceCAR) <- colnames(TerrorIndiceReturns)
# Compile for all indices
TerrorIndiceCAR <- do.call(cbind, TerrorIndiceCAR)
# 11-day CAR
TerrorIndiceCAR[11, ]
```

```
##      S.P500      Dow      NYSE      NASDAQ      Toronto      Mexico      London
## 10 -3.832794 -7.897366 -3.981837 -9.993519 -9.110412 -6.53973 -8.602633
##      Germany Eurostoxx50      France      Spain Switzerland      Austria      Italy
## 10 -10.45718 -7.596024 -9.518721 -10.6724 -7.292201 -7.894399 -15.21462
```

```
##      Belgium Amsterdam Portugal Helsinki Norway Sweden Tokyo
## 10 -9.219016 -10.82756 1.698079 -5.500048 -12.39281 -4.691903 -3.603373
##      HongKong S.Korea India Jakarta Singapore Kualalampur Australia
## 10 -5.231521 -16.64571 -17.02777 -9.933654 -17.98219 -14.55417 -8.597988
##      NZL Pakistan Saudi Israel Jberg
## 10 -5.635766 -12.42189 -11.32466 -7.81159 -12.59022
```

```
TerrorIndiceCAR[6, ] # 6-day CAR
```

```
##      S.P500 Dow NYSE NASDAQ Toronto Mexico London Germany
## 5 -7.72379 -10.56695 -8.094739 -10.13781 -7.01292 -13.17444 -4.533527 -8.063819
##      Eurostoxx50 France Spain Switzerland Austria Italy Belgium
## 5 -5.940704 -8.707865 -9.426443 -5.967055 -4.428614 -13.98185 -8.510382
##      Amsterdam Portugal Helsinki Norway Sweden Tokyo HongKong
## 5 -8.521101 -6.875878 -4.802975 -9.894391 -4.96208 -0.5636291 -5.570385
##      S.Korea India Jakarta Singapore Kualalampur Australia NZL
## 5 -11.81901 -11.77841 -4.91951 -13.74157 -10.50214 -6.814062 -7.101218
##      Pakistan Saudi Israel Jberg
## 5 -10.3741 -5.320904 -11.03399 -12.09548
```

Chapter 8

Advertising

People don't like intrusive ads, especially when they are vulnerable (Tybout and calkins, 2005, p.143)

Bibliography

- Akpinar, E. and Berger, J. (2017). Valuable virality. *Journal of Marketing Research*, 54(2):318–330.
- Berger, J. (2014). Word of mouth and interpersonal communication: A review and directions for future research. *Journal of Consumer Psychology*, 24(4):586–607.
- Chen, A. H. and Siems, T. F. (2004). The effects of terrorism on global capital markets. *European Journal of Political Economy*, 20(2):349–366.
- Libert, K. (2014). Age and gender matter in viral marketing. *Harvard Business Review*.
- Nagle, F. and Riedl, C. (2014). Online word of mouth and product quality disagreement. *Academy of Management Proceedings*, 2014(1):15681.
- Shapiro, B., Hitsch, G. J., and Tuchman, A. (2018). Generalizable and robust TV ad effects. *SSRN Electronic Journal*.
- Tybout, A. M. and calkins, T. (2005). *Kellogg on Branding*.
- Winterich, K. P., Gangwar, M., and Grewal, R. (2018). When celebrities count: Power distance beliefs and celebrity endorsements. *Journal of Marketing*, 82(3):70–86.
- Xie, Y. (2015). *Dynamic Documents with R and knitr*. Chapman and Hall/CRC, Boca Raton, Florida, 2nd edition. ISBN 978-1498716963.
- Xie, Y. (2020). *bookdown: Authoring Books and Technical Documents with R Markdown*. R package version 0.21.